



10 to the power 8 times

D-Waves computers are hyped to be about 10 to the power 8 times faster than traditional computer chips. <http://dgit.in/10power8>

The hospital 'Ransom'

In another cyber crime, hackers are demanding a ransom of \$17,000 from a hospital to get back access to key software along with diverting patients. <http://dgit.in/HsptlRansom>

Origins

at the Great Exhibition of the Works of Industry of All Nations at Hyde Park, London, in 1851. 'Stereographers', or photographers who would capture scenes and views from across the world for stereoscopes, came into being, and a large number of stereoviews and stereo cards were developed and sold. This was the very first instance of 3D viewing capturing widespread attention, and Sir David Brewster was commonly held as the inventor of the stereoscope.

This, however, was stated by Sir Brewster himself as undue credit. He stated that the very first concept of a stereoscope, albeit without the use of a lens or a mirror, was made by a Mathematics professor, Mr. Elliot. In his book titled 'The Stereoscope; Its History, Theory and Construction' published in 1856, he states that Mr. Elliot first gathered the understanding and concept of stereoscopic vision leading to perception of depth of an image when he wrote an essay for the University of Edinburgh's Class of Logic, back in 1823. Sir David's description of Mr. Elliot's very first experiment with obtaining a 3D image states, "Photography did not then exist, to enable Mr. Elliot to procure two views of the same scene, as seen by each eye, but he drew the transparency of a landscape with three distances. The first and most remote was the moon and the sky, and a stream of water from which the moon was reflected, the two moons being placed nearly at the distance of the two eyes, or 2 inches, and the two reflected moons at the same distance. The second distance was marked by an old cross about a hundred feet off; and the third distance by the withered branch of a tree, thirty feet from the observer. In the right-hand picture, one arm of the cross just touched the disc of the moon, while, in the left-hand one, it projected over one-third of the disc. The branch of the tree touched the outline of a distant hill in the one picture, but was "a full moon's-breadth" from it on the other. When these dissimilar pictures were united by the eyes, a landscape, certainly a very imperfect one, was seen in relief, composed of three distances." Mr. Elliot did not pursue this further owing to the difficulty of obtaining high quality images, and only



The first 3D film, shot in 1922, has been lost in the history of time

resorted back to his study when he noted Sir Charles Wheatstone's published paper in the Philosophical Magazine in March 1852, alongside contesting his claim of inventing stereoscopic 3D vision.

The first ever 3D movie

These were the initial stepping stones laid down by early pioneers in the field of 3D vision. The earliest known person to fidget with stereoscopes and 3D viewing in films was William Friese-Greene. A prolific inventor famous for his works in motion picture and the chronophotographic camera, which used celluloid as a medium for recording films and could capture up to 10 photographs per second on a perforated celluloid film, Friese-Greene experimented with cameras to create 3D vision on screen, thereby giving the cue to filmmakers and films that would follow. On September 27, 1922, Harry K. Fairall produced and directed a silent film, *The Power of Love*, using a red-and-green anaglyph 3D camera to shoot it. The film premiered at the Los Angeles Ambassador hotel, but did not generate massively favourable reviews.

This was the world's first 3D movie, and gave the audience the option to view alternate endings to the film. Viewers could watch the film through either the red eye or the green eye of the provided 3D glass, and could thus choose an alternate storyline (happy or sad), based on preference (although frighteningly interesting, we do not know which ending the majority chose to see). This move of providing two endings was owing to the use of the anaglyph 3D technology, presenting two different images that the brain synthesises into one. Unfortunately, however, the 3D version

failed to garner widespread interest, and was screened only one more time in front of the press, in New York City. Between 1923-24, Selznick Distributing Corporation procured the movie and screened it in 2D, under the name of *Forbidden Lover*.

The Golden Era of 3D (1952-54)

The very first experiment with 3D in films did not capture the fancy of the public the way stereoscopes did with still images, and it was a long, three-decade wait until *Bwana Devil* in 1952 garnered notable attention. Written, directed and produced by Arch Oboler, *Bwana Devil* accounted for a number of world's-first records, such as the world's first 3D film in colour, and the world's first full-length feature film with audio. The film also sparked the craze for 3D movies across the 1950s, and was advertised with the tagline, "A lion in your lap! A lover in your arms!"

The film was shot in Natural Vision 3D process, devised by Milton and Julian Gunzburg. They had pitched the system to a number of production houses including 20th Century Fox, Columbia, Paramount



Bwana Devil, based on a true story, gave birth to the golden era of 3D films

and Metro-Goldwyn Mayer, all of whom had turned it down. Oboler went ahead, shot and presented the *Bwana Devil*, which would later go on to become a milestone. The film was presented dual-strip, with Polaroid filters. This spawned filmmakers into action, and gave rise to what is now referred to as the golden era of 3D films (1952-54), screening films like *Man in the Dark* and *House of Wax* (first 3D